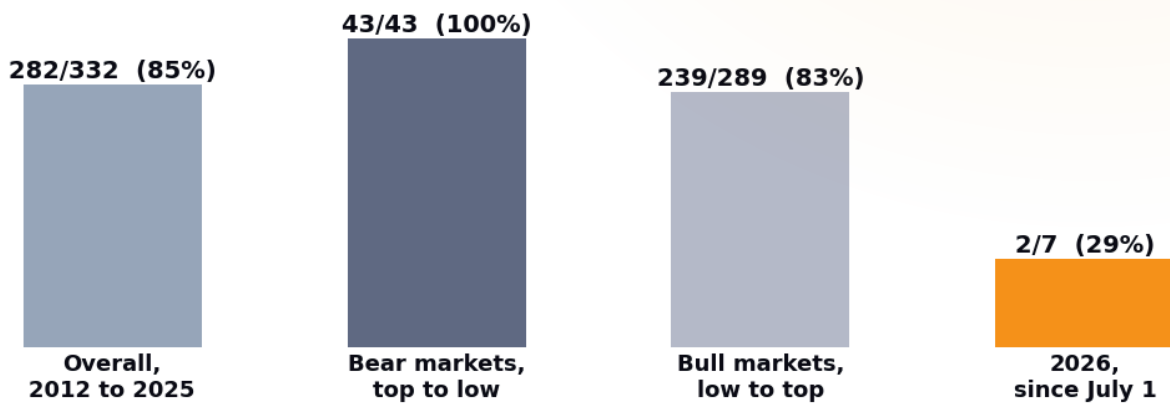


THE BIG CANDLE STUDY

Do massive green candles always get filled? Inside every past Bitcoin bear market, yes, every single one. Since July 2026, five have not.

Every massive green daily candle since 2012, overall, in bear markets and in bull markets, the ones that never filled, 2026 candle by candle, and the first three months after every bear low compared with today.



share of massive green daily candles that price later came back to (their open). Bitstamp daily.

43 of 43

filled inside past bear markets

50

never filled, all in bull markets

5

open since the July 2026 low

Educational, not financial advice. A massive green candle is a daily candle with a body at least twice the average of the prior 20 days and at least 4%. A fill means price later trades back to its open.



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THE RECORD

OVERALL VS BEAR VS BULL

MASSIVE GREEN CANDLES	FILLED EVER	WITHIN 7 DAYS	WITHIN 30 DAYS	TYPICAL WAIT	NEVER FILLED
Overall, 2012 to the 2025 top	282/332 (85%)	142/332 (43%)	209/332 (63%)	7 days	50
Bear markets, top to final low	43/43 (100%)	21/43 (49%)	37/43 (86%)	8 days	0
Bull markets, final low to next top	239/289 (83%)	121/289 (42%)	172/289 (60%)	7 days	50
2026, top to July 1	10/10 (100%)	6/10 (60%)	8/10 (80%)	6 days	0
2026, since July 1	2/7 (29%)	1/7 (14%)	2/5 (40%)	12 days	5

Bear = from a cycle top to that bear's final low. Bull = from a final low to the next top. Bitstamp BTC/USD daily, January 2012 to today.

Inside bear markets every massive green candle was erased, most of them within a month. In bull markets about one in six never was. 2026 followed the bear pattern exactly until July 1, then stopped.

THE EXCEPTIONS

THE CANDLES THAT NEVER FILLED

YEAR	MASSIVE GREEN CANDLES NEVER FILLED
2012	4
2013	13
2015	3
2016	6
2017	7
2018	1
2019	2
2020	5
2023	7
2024	2

All 50 came in bull markets. None came between a cycle top and that bear's final low.

Several came in the first days and weeks after a bear's final low: 15 January 2015, the day after the 2015 low; 17 December 2018, two days after the 2018 low; and 12 and 13 January 2023, seven weeks after the 2022 low. The candles that start a new cycle are the ones price never comes back to.

2026

THIS BEAR, CANDLE BY CANDLE

DAY	BODY	OPEN	FILLED
02 Dec 2025	+5.8%	\$86,291	15 Dec, 13 days
13 Jan 2026	+4.6%	\$91,195	20 Jan, 7 days
06 Feb 2026	+12.3%	\$62,795	24 Feb, 18 days
25 Feb 2026	+6.1%	\$64,059	28 Feb, 3 days
02 Mar 2026	+4.6%	\$65,776	08 Mar, 6 days
04 Mar 2026	+6.4%	\$68,336	06 Mar, 2 days
23 Mar 2026	+4.5%	\$67,853	27 Mar, 4 days
07 Apr 2026	+4.5%	\$68,856	02 Jun, 56 days
13 Apr 2026	+5.2%	\$70,742	01 Jun, 49 days
07 Jun 2026	+4.1%	\$60,851	09 Jun, 2 days
14 Jul 2026	+4.4%	\$62,257	01 Aug, 18 days
19 Aug 2026	+7.1%	\$64,686	open, 10% filled
20 Aug 2026	+5.4%	\$69,298	open, 0% filled
21 Aug 2026	+7.3%	\$73,000	open, 64% filled
03 Sep 2026	+5.1%	\$77,295	10 Sep, 7 days
18 Sep 2026	+5.9%	\$76,355	open, 17% filled
21 Sep 2026	+6.7%	\$81,152	open, 74% filled

Every massive green daily candle since the 6 October 2025 top.

From the top to the 1 July low, all ten were filled, the same as every past bear. Since 1 July, two of seven have been filled and five are still open.

THE OPEN FIVE

WHERE THE OPEN CANDLES START



Bitcoin daily since the Jul 1 low. Orange = massive green candles not filled yet. Dashed = their opens.

Filling all five means a trip back to \$64,686, the open of the 19 August candle. The nearest, 21 September, needs \$81,152.

Counting only engulfing candles, where the big candle swallows a previous candle that went the other way, the bear-market record is the same and the 2026 picture is narrower: the Sep 21 candle is the only engulfing one still open. Aug 19, 20, 21 and Sep 18 were not engulfing, which is why this study counts every massive green candle.

IF JULY WAS THE BOTTOM

THE FIRST 3 MONTHS AFTER A LOW

LOW	MASSIVE CANDLES	FILLED BY DAY 97	OPEN ON DAY 97	OF THOSE, NEVER FILLED	PRICE ON DAY 97
2011 bottom	15	12	3	2	+109%
2015 bottom	6	4	2	1	+55%
2018 bottom	6	3	3	3	+28%
2022 bottom	7	2	5	2	+52%
2014 bear rally (not a bottom)	7	3	4	0	+83%
2026, Jul 1	7	2	5	open	+48%

Every window covers the 97 days after the low; the low's own candle is not counted. The 2014 bear rally starts at the 11 April 2014 local low and is not a final bottom.

On candle count alone, 2026 looks like 2022: seven candles, two filled, five open. But the 2014 bear rally looked like that too, with four open. What separated them came later. After every real bottom at least one open candle was never filled. In the 2014 bear rally all four were, and the bear went on to new lows.

The limits. Four bottoms and one bear rally is a small sample. A fill can take months; the slowest inside a bear took 175 days. None of this says when, or whether, the five open candles fill. It only shows which past pattern each outcome would match.

Data pinned 7 October 2026. Bitstamp BTC/USD daily bars. Scripts: Engulfing/eg_study.py, Engulfing/bc_charts.py. This is education, not financial advice.

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